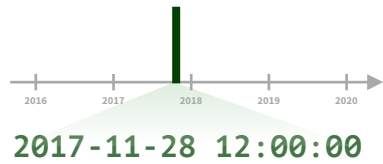


# Dates and times with lubridate : : CHEATSHEET



## Date-times



**2017-11-28 12:00:00**  
A **date-time** is a point on the timeline, stored as the number of seconds since 1970-01-01 00:00:00 UTC

```
dt <- as_datetime(1511870400)
## "2017-11-28 12:00:00 UTC"
```

### PARSE DATE-TIMES (Convert strings or numbers to date-times)

1. Identify the order of the year (**y**), month (**m**), day (**d**), hour (**h**), minute (**m**) and second (**s**) elements in your data.
2. Use the function below whose name replicates the order. Each accepts a tz argument to set the time zone, e.g. ymd(x, tz = "UTC").

**2017-11-28T14:02:00** `ymd_hms(), ymd_hm(), ymd_h().`  
`ymd_hms("2017-11-28T14:02:00")`

**2017-22-12 10:00:00** `ydm_hms(), ydm_hm(), ydm_h().`  
`ydm_hms("2017-22-12 10:00:00")`

**11/28/2017 1:02:03** `mdy_hms(), mdy_hm(), mdy_h().`  
`mdy_hms("11/28/2017 1:02:03")`

**1 Jan 2017 23:59:59** `dmy_hms(), dmy_hm(), dmy_h().`  
`dmy_hms("1 Jan 2017 23:59:59")`

**20170131** `ymd(), ydm().` `ymd(20170131)`

**July 4th, 2000** `mdy(), myd().` `mdy("July 4th, 2000")`

**4th of July '99** `dmy(), dym().` `dmy("4th of July '99")`

**2001: Q3** `yq()` Q for quarter. `yq("2001: Q3")`

**07-2020** `my(), ym().` `my("07-2020")`

**2:01** `hms::hms()` Also `lubridate::hms(), hm()` and `ms()`, which return periods.\* `hms::hms(seconds = 0, minutes = 1, hours = 2)`

**2017.5** `date_decimal(decimal, tz = "UTC")`  
`date_decimal(2017.5)`

**now(tzone = "")** Current time in tz (defaults to system tz). `now()`

**today(tzone = "")** Current date in a tz (defaults to system tz). `today()`

**fast\_strptime()** Faster strptime. `fast_strptime("9/1/01", "%y/%m/%d")`

**parse\_date\_time()** Easier strptime. `parse_date_time("09-01-01", "ymd")`

**2017-11-28**  
A **date** is a day stored as the number of days since 1970-01-01

```
d <- as_date(17498)
## "2017-11-28"
```

**12:00:00**  
An **hms** is a **time** stored as the number of seconds since 00:00:00

```
t <- hms::as_hms(85)
## "00:01:25"
```

### GET AND SET COMPONENTS

Use an accessor function to get a component.  
Assign into an accessor function to change a component in place.

```
d ## "2017-11-28"
day(d) ## 28
day(d) <- 1
d ## "2017-11-01"
```

**2018-01-31 11:59:59** `date(x)` Date component. `date(dt)`

**2018-01-31 11:59:59** `year(x)` Year. `year(dt)`  
`isoyear(x)` The ISO 8601 year.  
`epiyear(x)` Epidemiological year.

**2018-01-31 11:59:59** `month(x, label, abbr)` Month. `month(dt)`

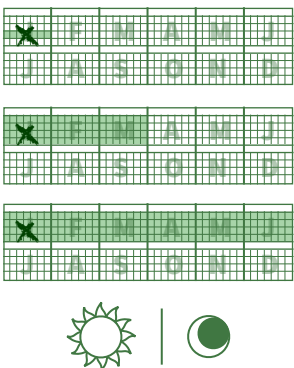
**2018-01-31 11:59:59** `day(x)` Day of month. `day(dt)`  
`wday(x, label, abbr)` Day of week.  
`qday(x)` Day of quarter.

**2018-01-31 11:59:59** `hour(x)` Hour. `hour(dt)`

**2018-01-31 11:59:59** `minute(x)` Minutes. `minute(dt)`

**2018-01-31 11:59:59** `second(x)` Seconds. `second(dt)`

**2018-01-31 11:59:59 UTC** `tz(x)` Time zone. `tz(dt)`



**2018-01-31 11:59:59** `week(x)` Week of the year. `week(dt)`  
`isoweek()` ISO 8601 week.  
`epiweek()` Epidemiological week.

**2018-01-31 11:59:59** `quarter(x)` Quarter. `quarter(dt)`

**2018-01-31 11:59:59** `semester(x, with_year = FALSE)` Semester. `semester(dt)`

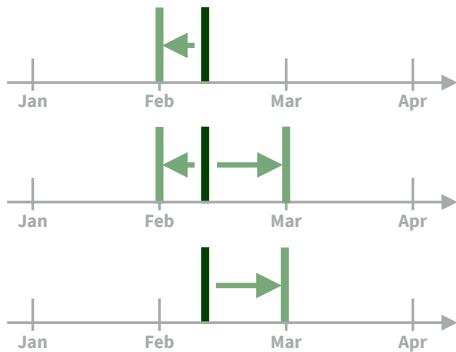
**2018-01-31 11:59:59** `am(x)` Is it in the am? `am(dt)`  
`pm(x)` Is it in the pm? `pm(dt)`

**2018-01-31 11:59:59** `dst(x)` Is it daylight savings? `dst(d)`

**2018-01-31 11:59:59** `leap_year(x)` Is it a leap year? `leap_year(d)`

**2018-01-31 11:59:59** `update(object, ..., simple = FALSE)`  
`update(dt, mday = 2, hour = 1)`

## Round Date-times



**floor\_date(x, unit = "second")**  
Round down to nearest unit.  
`floor_date(dt, unit = "month")`

**round\_date(x, unit = "second")**  
Round to nearest unit.  
`round_date(dt, unit = "month")`

**ceiling\_date(x, unit = "second")**  
Round up to nearest unit.  
`ceiling_date(dt, unit = "month")`

Valid units are second, minute, hour, day, week, month, bimonth, quarter, season, halfyear and year.

**rollback(dates, roll\_to\_first = FALSE, preserve\_hms = TRUE)** Roll back to last day of previous month. Also **rollforward()**. `rollback(dt)`

## Stamp Date-times

**stamp()** Derive a template from an example string and return a new function that will apply the template to date-times. Also **stamp\_date()** and **stamp\_time()**.

1. Derive a template, create a function  
`sf <- stamp("Created Sunday, Jan 17, 1999 3:34")`
2. Apply the template to dates  
`sf(ymd("2010-04-05"))`  
`## [1] "Created Monday, Apr 05, 2010 00:00"`

**Tip: use a date with day > 12**

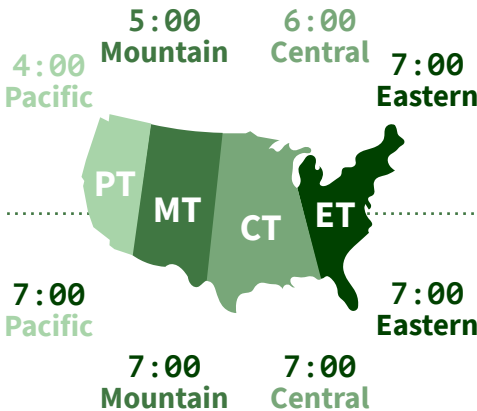
## Time Zones

R recognizes ~600 time zones. Each encodes the time zone, Daylight Savings Time, and historical calendar variations for an area. R assigns one time zone per vector.

Use the **UTC** time zone to avoid Daylight Savings.

**OlsonNames()** Returns a list of valid time zone names. `OlsonNames()`

**Sys.timezone()** Gets current time zone.



**with\_tz(time, tzone = "")** Get the **same date-time** in a new time zone (a new clock time). Also **local\_time(dt, tz, units)**. `with_tz(dt, "US/Pacific")`

**force\_tz(time, tzone = "")** Get the **same clock time** in a new time zone (a new date-time). Also **force\_tzs()**. `force_tz(dt, "US/Pacific")`

# Math with Date-times — Lubridate provides three classes of timespans to facilitate math with dates and date-times.



Math with date-times relies on the **timeline**, which behaves inconsistently. Consider how the timeline behaves during:

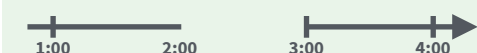
## A normal day

```
nor <- ymd_hms("2018-01-01 01:30:00", tz="US/Eastern")
```



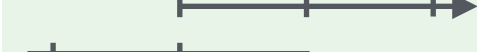
## The start of daylight savings (spring forward)

```
gap <- ymd_hms("2018-03-11 01:30:00", tz="US/Eastern")
```



## The end of daylight savings (fall back)

```
lap <- ymd_hms("2018-11-04 00:30:00", tz="US/Eastern")
```



## Leap years and leap seconds

```
leap <- ymd("2019-03-01")
```



**Periods** track changes in clock times, which ignore time line irregularities.

nor + minutes(90)



gap + minutes(90)



lap + minutes(90)



leap + years(1)

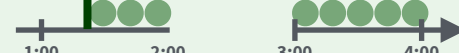


**Durations** track the passage of physical time, which deviates from clock time when irregularities occur.

nor + dminutes(90)



gap + dminutes(90)



lap + dminutes(90)



leap + dyears(1)



**Intervals** represent specific intervals of the timeline, bounded by start and end date-times.

interval(nor, nor + minutes(90))



interval(gap, gap + minutes(90))



interval(lap, lap + minutes(90))



interval(leap, leap + years(1))



Not all years are 365 days due to **leap days**.

Not all minutes are 60 seconds due to **leap seconds**.

It is possible to create an imaginary date by adding **months**, e.g. February 31st

```
jan31 <- ymd(20180131)
jan31 + months(1)
## NA
```

**%m+%** and **%m-%** will roll imaginary dates to the last day of the previous month.

```
jan31 %m+% months(1)
## "2018-02-28"
```

**add\_with\_rollback(e1, e2, roll\_to\_first = TRUE)** will roll imaginary dates to the first day of the new month.

```
add_with_rollback(jan31, months(1),
roll_to_first = TRUE)
## "2018-03-01"
```

## PERIODS

Add or subtract periods to model events that happen at specific clock times, like the NYSE opening bell.

Make a period with the name of a time unit **pluralized**, e.g.

```
p <- months(3) + days(12)
```

**"3m 12d 0H 0M 0S"**

Number of months Number of days etc.

**years(x = 1)** x years.

**months(x = 1)** x months.

**weeks(x = 1)** x weeks.

**days(x = 1)** x days.

**hours(x = 1)** x hours.

**minutes(x = 1)** x minutes.

**seconds(x = 1)** x seconds.

**milliseconds(x = 1)** x milliseconds.

**microseconds(x = 1)** x microseconds.

**nanoseconds(x = 1)** x nanoseconds.

**picoseconds(x = 1)** x picoseconds.

**period(num = NULL, units = "second", ...)**  
An automation friendly period constructor.  
period(5, unit = "years")

**as.period(x, unit)** Coerce a timespan to a period, optionally in the specified units.  
Also **is.period()**. as.period(p)

**period\_to\_seconds(x)** Convert a period to the "standard" number of seconds implied by the period. Also **seconds\_to\_period()**.  
period\_to\_seconds(p)

## DURATIONS

Add or subtract durations to model physical processes, like battery life. Durations are stored as seconds, the only time unit with a consistent length. **Diffimes** are a class of durations found in base R.

Make a duration with the name of a period prefixed with a **d**, e.g.

```
dd <- ddays(14)
```

**"1209600s (~2 weeks)"**

Exact length in seconds Equivalent in common units

**dyears(x = 1)** 31536000x seconds.

**dmonths(x = 1)** 2629800x seconds.

**dweeks(x = 1)** 604800x seconds.

**ddays(x = 1)** 86400x seconds.

**dhours(x = 1)** 3600x seconds.

**dminutes(x = 1)** 60x seconds.

**dseconds(x = 1)** x seconds.

**dmilliseconds(x = 1)**  $x \times 10^{-3}$  seconds.

**dmicroseconds(x = 1)**  $x \times 10^{-6}$  seconds.

**dnanoseconds(x = 1)**  $x \times 10^{-9}$  seconds.

**dpicoseconds(x = 1)**  $x \times 10^{-12}$  seconds.

**duration(num = NULL, units = "second", ...)**  
An automation friendly duration constructor. duration(5, unit = "years")

**as.duration(x, ...)** Coerce a timespan to a duration. Also **is.duration()**, **is.diffime()**.  
as.duration(i)

**make\_diffime(x)** Make diffime with the specified number of units.  
make\_diffime(99999)

## INTERVALS

Divide an interval by a duration to determine its physical length, divide an interval by a period to determine its implied length in clock time.

Make an interval with **interval()** or **%--%**, e.g.

```
i <- interval(ymd("2017-01-01"), d)
```

```
j <- d %--% ymd("2017-12-31")
```

**## 2017-01-01 UTC--2017-11-28 UTC**

**## 2017-11-28 UTC--2017-12-31 UTC**



**a %within% b** Does interval or date-time *a* fall within interval *b*? now() %within% i



**int\_start(int)** Access/set the start date-time of an interval. Also **int\_end()**. int\_start(i) <- now(); int\_start(i)



**int\_aligns(int1, int2)** Do two intervals share a boundary? Also **int\_overlaps()**. int\_aligns(i, j)



**int\_diff(times)** Make the intervals that occur between the date-times in a vector.  
v <- c(dt, dt + 100, dt + 1000); int\_diff(v)



**int\_flip(int)** Reverse the direction of an interval. Also **int\_standardize()**. int\_flip(i)



**int\_length(int)** Length in seconds. int\_length(i)



**int\_shift(int, by)** Shifts an interval up or down the timeline by a timespan. int\_shift(i, days(-1))

**as.interval(x, start, ...)** Coerce a timespan to an interval with the start date-time. Also **is.interval()**. as.interval(days(1), start = now())